merchandise, films, literature, sports events, and music that entered Cuba during these years, *son* represented an important symbol of national identity" notes ethnomusicologist Robin Moore.[26] In this respect, Cubans played a part in the worldwide phenomenon of *négritude*, in their own way. *Négritude* drew together blacks in the French-speaking world, from independent Haiti to the French colonies of the Caribbean and West Africa, asserting the value and promotion of black experiences and cultures.

Black Cuban intellectuals also looked to the Harlem Renaissance of the 1920s and the flourishing of black intellectual and cultural life that it encompassed. Afro-Cuban writers like poet Nicolás Guillén and newspaper columnist Gustavo Urrutia developed close ties with U.S. colleagues like poet Langston Hughes and Afro-Puerto Rican Arthur Schomburg, curator of his own African-themed collections at the New York Public Library. White Cuban intellectuals like Fernando Ortíz and Ramiro Guerra y Sánchez were deeply influenced by these currents in black thought as they struggled to analyze Cuba's colonial history and its ongoing economic and political dependence. Critiques of U.S. imperialism in Cuba, of white supremacy in the United States, and of Cuba's own history of racial inequality, were all intertwined.

Numerous organizations grew out of the ferment of the 1920s. University students founded the FEU, or Federación Estudiantil Universitaria, in 1923. Cuba's Communist Party had its roots in the Cuban labor movement of the 1920s. The country's growing labor organizations formed a national federation, the Confederación Nacional Obrera de Cuba (CNOC) in 1925, and some of its leaders founded the Partido Comunista de Cuba (PCC) later the same year. During its first decade the PCC followed the lead of the Comintern (which it had quickly affiliated with) in focusing its activities on developing political influence in the urban labor movement, in which it played a major role. Stalin had declared the Comintern's "Third Period" in 1928, instructing the world's Communist parties to create militant labor unions based on the philosophy of class struggle. In the early 1930s, the Party expanded its reach into the rural areas, organizing agricultural workers and